

LEAH SHEILA WANJIKU

Corporate Finance | Capital Raising | Investment Appraisal & Financial Modelling

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Corporate Financial Analyst and CFA Level I candidate with 6+ years of progressive experience at Acorn Holdings. Skilled in financial modelling, investor memos and data rooms for blended debt and equity raises with DFIs and concessional investors. Cut operational costs by 15% and built the models behind multiple live funding transactions.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Capital Raising:** investor memos, data rooms, investor Q&A, concessional TA funding, DFI and investor engagement
- **Modelling & Appraisal:** DCF/NPV, IRR, LTV, three-statement models, sensitivity analysis, feasibility studies, credit and valuation analysis
- **Reporting & Monitoring:** forecast-to-actual reviews, variance analysis, KPI dashboards, management and financing reports
- **Tools:** Advanced Excel, Power BI, Power Query, SQL, Sage ERP, n8n, Asana, HubSpot CRM

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Corporate Financial Analyst | Acorn Holdings Limited

Jan 2025 to Apr 2026

- Moved a blended debt and equity raise for a Kenya PBSA project (Mauritius SPV) toward first close by building the integrated financial model (revenue, CAPEX, ROI, IRR, LTV, REIT share) that investors and DFIs used to assess the deal.
- Gave prospective investors a clear basis for their decisions by writing the investor memo that set out the vehicle's structure, returns and key risks.
- Kept investor due diligence moving by setting up the data room, issuing investor access, answering queries and following up after every meeting.
- Widened the project's funding strategy by searching for technical assistance (TA) funding from concessional investors.
- Enabled leadership, investors and DFIs to judge project viability and funding needs across multiple live transactions by building integrated models for debt and equity financing decisions.
- Protected the quality of outputs reaching funders and senior stakeholders by reviewing financial statements and data and resolving discrepancies before submission.
- Gave management and funders timely insight into performance and assumptions by coordinating forecast-to-actual reviews across Finance, Business Development and Operations.
- Gave management one standard view of financial and operational KPIs by designing Power BI dashboards.

Business Development Analyst | Acorn Holdings Limited

May 2024 to Dec 2024

- Reduced leadership sign-off time on new business cases by replacing ad-hoc analysis with standard feasibility studies and financial-assessment frameworks.
- Improved investment and budget decisions by producing feasibility studies that assessed commercial viability, financial potential and key risks.
- Enabled earlier course-correction on active initiatives by tracking business-case assumptions against actual performance and flagging divergence from plan.
- Standardised team performance reporting by building recurring dashboards and management reports that became the default monitoring format.

Business Administrator | Acorn Holdings Limited

Dec 2019 to Apr 2024

- Cut operational costs by 15% by identifying workflow inefficiencies and applying Lean Six Sigma improvements.
- Strengthened internal controls by reviewing procurement and expense transactions for accuracy before processing.
- Maintained audit readiness by organising operational records and internal-control documentation for review.
- Gave management reliable data for reporting by supporting budgeting, procurement and vendor expense tracking across departments.

Finance Intern / Management Trainee Associate | Acorn Holdings Limited

Feb 2021 to Feb 2022

- Contributed to an on-time month-end close with zero reconciliation errors flagged by performing account reconciliations and transaction processing.
- Caught discrepancies before they reached reporting by extracting and validating financial data from Sage ERP via Citrix.

SELECTED FINANCIAL MODELLING PROJECTS (GITHUB.COM/LEAHSHEILA2-SVG)

- **Credit Analysis Model:** credit memorandum for a proposed KES 5.0bn facility with ratio analysis, 5C's risk assessment and covenant structuring.
- **Integrated Bank Valuation Model:** three-statement operating and valuation model with DCF/NPV and sensitivity analysis.
- **REIT Valuation Model:** integrated three-statement forecast with DCF, DDM, NAV and cap-rate analysis.

- **B2B SaaS Financial & Reporting Model:** recurring-revenue model covering MRR, retention, operating performance and forecasting.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **CFA Level I:** in progress, exam February 2027
- **Bachelor of Business Management (Banking & Finance)**, Mount Kenya University, 2019 to 2023
- **Financial Modeling & Valuation Analyst (FMVA, FAST Standard)**, Invhestia, 2023
- **Introduction to International Securities & Investment**, CISI, 2023
- **CPA Foundation Level**, KASNEB, 2021
- **Lean Six Sigma Yellow Belt**, Life Skills, 2018
- **Diploma in Business Administration & Management**, Zetech University, 2016 to 2018

Referees are available upon request.